

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT (BRD)

Project Information

Item	Value
Project Name	Learning Engagement & Course Completion Optimization
Product Type	Online Learning Platform (Udemy App)
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Document Type	Business Requirements Document

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1. Executive Summary

Although Udemy achieves a high course enrollment rate, the course completion rate remains relatively low. Analysis of learner behavior indicates that many users discontinue learning after the initial enrollment stage due to declining motivation and the absence of immediate rewards for consistent learning activities.

While Udemy currently provides a basic Streak feature to encourage daily learning, the platform lacks a comprehensive engagement mechanism that recognizes learner achievements and rewards continued participation.

To address this challenge, the project proposes the implementation of a Learning Engagement & Rewards System. The solution leverages the existing Streak infrastructure and introduces a gamification layer consisting of point accumulation, achievement recognition, and reward redemption.

The proposed solution includes four key components:

- Point Engine: Award points based on eligible learning activities and learning streak milestones.
- Achievement System: Recognize learner accomplishments through badges and milestone achievements.
- Reward Center: Allow learners to redeem accumulated points for platform-related rewards.
- Anti-Cheat & Ledger System: Ensure point integrity through transaction tracking and abuse prevention mechanisms.

The primary objective of this initiative is to increase learner engagement, improve course completion rates, and encourage continuous learning behavior without significantly changing the existing learning workflow.

This document defines the business requirements, functional requirements, business rules, and success metrics for the proposed solution.

2. Business Context

2.1 Current Product

Udemy is an online learning platform that enables learners to discover, purchase, and complete courses across various professional and personal development topics.

The platform currently provides the following core capabilities:

- Course Discovery & Search
- Course Enrollment & Payment
- Video-based Learning Experience
- Course Progress Tracking
- Learning Streak Tracking
- Certificate Issuance

2.2 Current Learning Journey

The typical learner journey is as follows:

Browse Course → Enroll Course → Start Learning → Learning Interruption → Reduced Engagement → Course Abandonment

While learners can easily enroll in courses, many fail to maintain consistent learning behavior after the initial learning sessions.

3. Current State Analysis

3.1 Business Performance Analysis

(Note: The metrics below are assumed business data created for analytical and educational purposes only. They are used to illustrate the current business challenges and support the proposed solution design)

KPI Overview	Current Value
Total Enrollments	10,000
Started Course	8,500
Completed Course	2,000
Completion Rate	20%
Weekly Active Learners	30%
Average Learning Hours	1h
7-Day Streak Achievement Rate	12%

The current performance metrics indicate a significant gap between course enrollment and course completion. Although learners actively enroll in courses, only a small proportion complete their learning journey.

3.2 Learner Feedback Analysis

The analysis suggests that learner disengagement is primarily driven by motivational factors rather than platform usability issues:

User Survey Result (Issues)	Percentage
Lack of Motivation to Continue Learning	45%
No Tangible Rewards for Learning Progress	25%
Learning Achievements Not Recognized	15%
Difficulty Maintaining Learning Consistency	10%
Others	5%

4. Problem Statement

Analysis of learner behavior and engagement metrics indicates that a significant proportion of enrolled learners fail to maintain consistent learning activities and complete their courses.

The primary causes include:

Problem 1: The platform lacks a meaningful incentive mechanism that encourages continuous learning behavior.

Problem 2: Learners receive limited recognition for learning achievements and milestone accomplishments.

Problem 3: The current Streak feature provides limited long-term engagement value and lacks recovery options for inactive periods.

As a result, learner motivation gradually declines, contributing to lower engagement levels and reduced course completion rates.

5. Business Objectives

The primary objective is to improve learner engagement and encourage consistent learning behavior through the introduction of a gamification-based reward system. By encouraging learners to return regularly and complete more courses, the platform is expected to increase course completion rates, stimulate repeat course purchases through discount vouchers, and ultimately contribute to higher customer lifetime value (CLV) and revenue growth.

The following business objectives are expected to be achieved within six months after deployment:

BO1 – Improve Course Completion Rate

Increase Course Completion Rate from 20% to 28%.

BO2 – Increase Weekly Active Learners

Increase Weekly Active Learners (WAL) from 30% to 40%.

BO3 – Improve Learning Consistency

Increase the percentage of learners achieving a 7-Day Learning Streak from 12% to 20%.

BO4 – Increase Reward System Adoption

Achieve at least 30% of active learners earning points through eligible learning activities.

BO5 – Increase Reward Redemption Participation

Achieve at least 15% of active learners redeeming rewards from the Reward Center.

BO6 – Improve Average Learning Time

Increase average learning time from 1 hour/week to 1.5 hours/week.

Success Metrics

KPI	Current	Target (Sau 6 tháng)
Completion Rate	20%	28%
Weekly Active Learners	30%	40%
Reward Redemption Rate	N/A	15%
7-Day Streak Users	12%	15%

6. Scope Management

6.1 In Scope

The following capabilities are included within the scope of the current release:

S1. Point Earning System

- Award points based on eligible learning activities
- Award bonus points for achieving streak milestones
- Display current point balance to learners

S2. Achievement System

- Define achievement milestones and badge criteria
- Award badges upon milestone completion
- Display unlocked achievements within the learner dashboard

S3. Reward Center

- Display available rewards and redemption costs
- Allow learners to redeem points for rewards

S4. Streak Freeze Mechanism

- Allow learners to redeem a Streak Freeze reward
- Prevent streak loss under eligible conditions

S5. Point Transaction Tracking

- Record all point earning and redemption activities
- Maintain accurate point balances and transaction history

S6. Anti-Abuse Controls

- Prevent invalid point accumulation

- Enforce daily point earning limits
- Validate reward redemption eligibility

6.2 Out of Scope

The following capabilities are excluded from the current release:

Reward & Commerce Integration

- Automatic voucher code generation
- Shopping cart integration
- Checkout and payment integration

Social & Community Features

- Leaderboards
- Learning communities
- Social sharing
- Peer challenges

AI Features

- AI Tutor
- AI Learning Assistant
- Personalized course recommendations

6.3 Future Considerations

The following enhancements may be considered for future releases to further improve learner engagement and learning effectiveness:

F1. Study Planning

- Create personalized study schedules

- Manage learning plans across multiple courses

F2. Learning Reminders

- Push notifications for planned study sessions
- Email reminders for inactive learners

F3. Personalized Learning Experience

- Learning goal recommendations
- Adaptive study plans based on learner behavior

F4. Social Learning Features

- Group learning challenges
- Achievement sharing
- Community engagement activities

7. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role	
Product Owner	Product Direction & Approval	High
Business Analyst	Requirement Management & System Analysis	High
Development Team	System Architecture & Development	High
QA Team	Testing & Quality Assurance	Medium
Learner	End User	High
Marketing Team	Define reward campaigns and promotional voucher strategies	Medium
Customer Support Team	Handle learner inquiries related to rewards and point redemption	Medium

8. Assumptions & Constraints

8.1 Assumptions

A01 – Existing Learning Platform Availability

The existing Udemy learning platform, including course enrollment, course progress tracking, and Streak functionality, remains operational and available for integration.

A02 – Active Learner Participation

Learners participating in the reward program have at least one enrolled course and engage in learning activities regularly.

A03 – Existing Streak Service Reusability

The current Streak tracking mechanism can be reused without requiring significant modifications to support the proposed gamification features.

A04 – Reward Budget Availability

The business is willing to allocate sufficient promotional budget to support reward redemption activities such as discount vouchers.

8.2 Constraints

Constraint ID	Constraint	Value
C01	Project Timeline	≤ 3 months
C02	Page Load Time Impact	≤ 2 seconds
C03	Monthly Reward Budget	$\leq$ USD 5,000
C04	Existing Streak Service Reuse	Mandatory
C05	Existing Learning Flow Changes	Minimal

9. Risks

Risk ID	Risk Description	Probability	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
R01	Learners may repeatedly complete very short lessons to maximize point earnings without meaningful learning engagement (Lesson Spamming).	Medium	High	Apply Daily Point Cap and minimum lesson completion validation.
R02	Learners may attempt to fast-forward videos to obtain points without actual learning activity.	High	High	Award points only after receiving valid completion events from the existing learning platform.
R03	Excessive reward redemption may increase marketing costs beyond the allocated budget (Point Inflation).	Medium	High	Implement redemption limits, point expiration rules, and periodic reward reviews.
R04	Learners may attempt to manipulate device time or timezone settings to exploit streak and daily reward mechanisms.	Low	Medium	Use server-side UTC time for streak calculations and daily resets.
R05	Learners may perceive rewards as insufficient and choose not to participate in the gamification system.	Medium	High	Continuously review reward attractiveness and monitor redemption rates after launch.
R06	Low adoption of the Reward Center may reduce the	Medium	Medium	Conduct post-launch monitoring

	expected business impact on learner engagement.			and adjust reward offerings based on learner behavior.
R07	System performance may degrade during peak learning periods due to additional point-tracking transactions.	Low	Medium	Optimize tracking services and conduct load testing before release.

10. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution consists of three key features designed to enhance learner engagement and retention.

Point Earning System

Learners earn points by completing eligible learning activities and maintaining learning streaks.

Achievement System

Learners unlock badges upon reaching predefined learning milestones to encourage consistent learning behavior.

Reward Center

Learners can redeem accumulated points for rewards such as discount vouchers and Streak Freeze Cards.

11. Detailed System Requirements

11.1 Business Requirements

BR01: Learners shall be able to earn points through eligible learning activities and learning streaks.

BR02: Learners shall receive achievement badges upon reaching predefined learning milestones.

BR03: Learners shall be able to redeem accumulated points for available rewards.

BR04: Learners shall be able to use Streak Freeze Cards to protect their learning streaks under eligible conditions.

BR05: The system shall ensure fair and consistent point earning and reward redemption.

11.2 Functional Requirements

Module A – Point Earning System

FR01 (Tracking Active Learning Time): The system shall track valid learning time based on actual learner activity.

FR02 (Lesson Point Earning): The system shall award +5 Points for lessons shorter than 10 minutes and +10 Points for lessons equal to or longer than 10 minutes.

FR03 (Streak Bonus): The system shall award bonus points for maintaining daily learning streaks and achieving streak milestones.

FR04 (Point Balance Display): The system shall display the learner's current point balance.

Module B – Achievement System

FR05 (Badge Awarding): The system shall automatically award achievement badges when learners reach predefined milestones.

FR06 (Achievement Display): The system shall display earned badges within the Achievement section.

Module C – Reward Center

FR07 (Reward Display): The system shall display available rewards and their redemption costs.

FR08 (Voucher Redemption): The system shall allow learners to redeem points for discount vouchers.

FR09 (Streak Freeze Redemption): The system shall allow learners to redeem points for Streak Freeze Cards.

FR10 (Point Deduction): The system shall deduct the corresponding number of points after successful redemption.

11.3 Business Rules

BRULE01 (Daily Cap): Learners may earn a maximum of 50 points per day from lesson completion activities.

BRULE02 (Valid Completion): Points shall only be awarded for valid lesson completion events verified by the learning platform.

BRULE03 (Point Expiry): Points shall expire after 90 consecutive days of inactivity.

BRULE04 (Freeze Card Limit): Each learner may use a maximum of one Streak Freeze Card per month.

BRULE05 (Sufficient Balance): Reward redemption shall not be allowed when the learner's point balance is lower than the reward cost.

11.4 Requirement Priority

Priority Level	Features
Must Have	Point Earning System, Point Balance Display, Achievement Badge Awarding, Reward Center, Voucher Redemption, Streak Freeze Redemption, Anti-Abuse Controls
Should Have	Streak Bonus Rewards, Achievement Display, Point Expiry Mechanism
Could Have	Additional Reward Types, Personalized Achievement Recommendations, Seasonal Reward Campaigns
Won't Have (Phase 1)	Study Planner, Learning Reminders, AI Tutor, Leaderboards, Learning Community, Social Sharing, Course Recommendation Engine

12. User Stories

US01: As a learner, I want to earn points from completing learning activities so that I feel motivated to continue learning.

US02: As a learner, I want to view my current point balance so that I can track my progress and plan reward redemptions.

US03: As a learner, I want to unlock achievement badges when reaching learning milestones so that I feel recognized for my efforts.

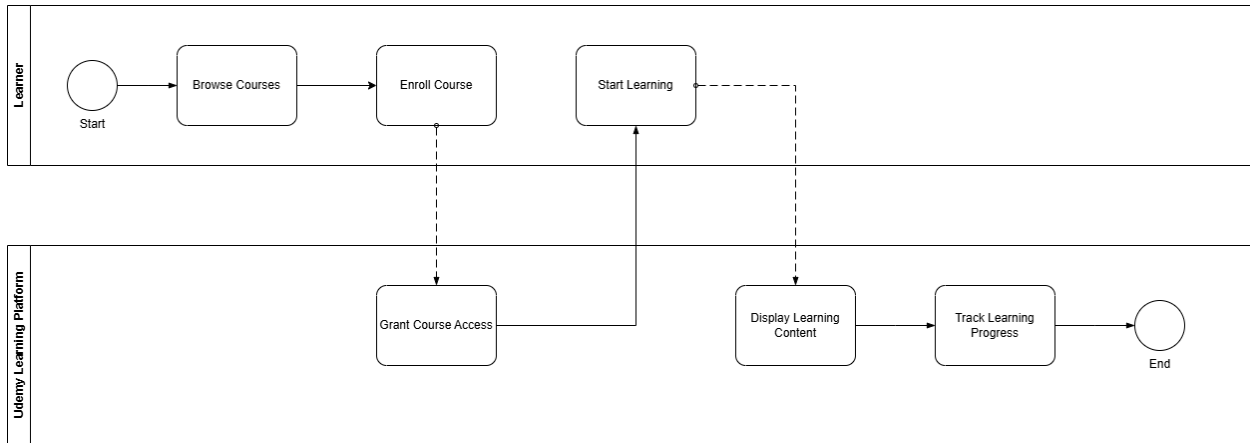
US04: As a learner, I want to browse available rewards and their point costs so that I can decide how to use my accumulated points.

US05: As a learner, I want to redeem points for discount vouchers so that I can save money on future course purchases.

US06: As a learner, I want to redeem and use a Streak Freeze Card so that I can protect my learning streak when I miss a study day.

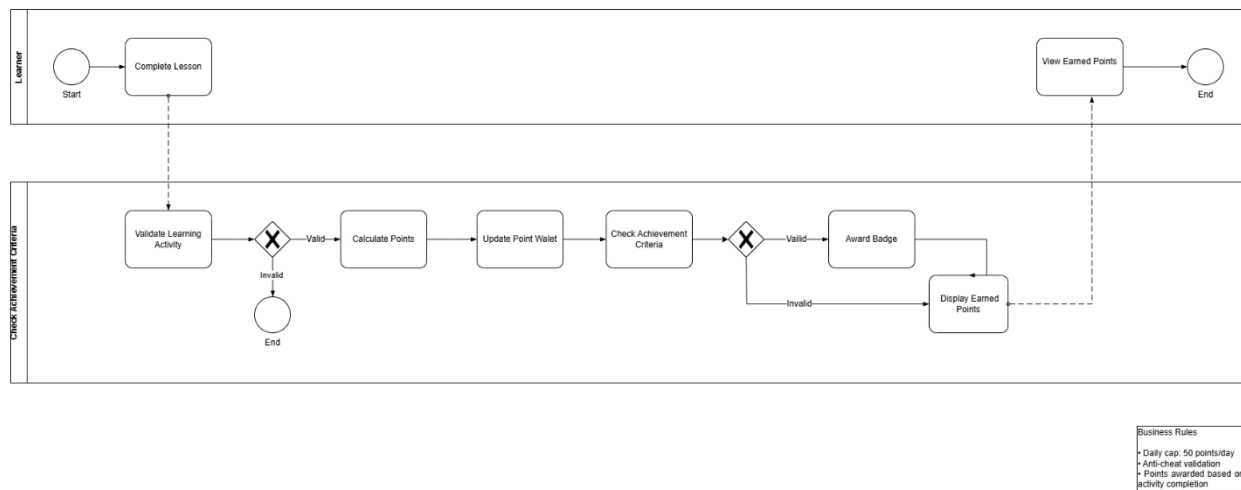
13. BPMN

As Is Diagram:



To Be Diagram:

Gamification Engine – Points & Badge Workflow



Reward Redemption Process

